

MVP Monetization Strategy & Payment Implementation

Updated Edition

1. Overview

SIMB Biz is testing different monetization models for small and medium businesses using an MVP approach. The objective is to identify the most effective pricing model based on customer adoption, willingness to pay, and retention.

The MVP currently provides two main solutions:

Online Store System

- ◆ Digital product catalog
- ◆ Product images
- ◆ Product videos
- ◆ Shareable product links

Business Management System

- ◆ Customer management
- ◆ Debt tracking
- ◆ Sales records
- ◆ Inventory management
- ◆ Basic business reports

2. Monetization Models

The MVP will test three pricing approaches, summarized below.

MODEL A — Online Store Subscription (SIMB Biz Store Pro)

10,000 FCFA/mo

For established businesses that need a professional online presence.

- ◆ Online store access
- ◆ Unlimited image uploads
- ◆ Controlled video uploads
- ◆ Product catalog management
- ◆ Product sharing links
- ◆ Basic store features

Note: Video uploads are capped, since video storage and bandwidth carry higher operational costs.

MODEL B — Atomic Pay-As-You-Grow

From Free

For small businesses that want to start free and expand gradually.

- ◆ Free tier: 10 free product spaces, basic digital catalog, image support
- ◆ Image product space: 200 FCFA per space (e.g. 10 spaces = 2,000 FCFA)
- ◆ Video product space: 500 FCFA per space (e.g. 10 spaces = 5,000 FCFA)
- ◆ Businesses purchase additional capacity once free spaces are used

MODEL C — Hybrid Business Management (Starter)

3,000 FCFA/mo

For small businesses beginning digital transformation.

- ◆ Customer management
- ◆ Debt tracking
- ◆ Sales recording
- ◆ Inventory management
- ◆ Small product catalog allowance

MODEL C — Hybrid Business Management (Growth)

15,000 FCFA/mo

For growing businesses that depend on daily sales operations.

- ◆ Full business management system
- ◆ Larger catalog capacity
- ◆ More product spaces
- ◆ Increased video capacity
- ◆ Advanced business reports

3. Payment System Implementation

Initial payment platforms: **MTN Mobile Money** and **Orange Money**. The payment architecture is designed to allow future payment integrations.

4. Payment Flow

Subscription Payment Flow

- ◆ Business selects a plan.
- ◆ System displays payment amount.
- ◆ User enters mobile money details.
- ◆ Payment request is initiated.
- ◆ Payment is verified.
- ◆ Plan is activated.
- ◆ Subscription expiry date is recorded.

The database should store the following fields:

```
User ID
Business ID
Selected plan
Payment amount
Payment date
Expiry date
Transaction ID
Payment status
```

5. Atomic Purchase Flow

Example: a business uses its 10 free product spaces and wants more.

- ◆ User selects additional product spaces.
- ◆ User chooses image spaces or video spaces.
- ◆ System calculates total cost.
- ◆ User pays through Mobile Money.
- ◆ Product capacity increases automatically.

Example calculation: 20 image spaces × 200 FCFA = 4,000 FCFA. New capacity: 10 free spaces + 20 purchased spaces = 30 total spaces.

6. Required Backend Features

User Account System

Stores: business profile, current plan, available product spaces, subscription status.

Product Capacity Management

```
business_id
image_slots_available
video_slots_available
subscription_plan
subscription_expiry
```

Payment Records

```
payment_id
business_id
amount
payment_method
transaction_reference
payment_status
created_at
```

Subscription Management

- ◆ Activate plans after successful payment.
- ◆ Track expiry dates.
- ◆ Notify users before expiration.
- ◆ Disable premium features after expiry.

7. Testing Objectives

The experiment should measure:

- ◆ Number of businesses registering.
- ◆ Number of businesses creating stores.
- ◆ Number of products uploaded.
- ◆ Number of paying customers.
- ◆ Preferred pricing model.
- ◆ Customer retention.

8. Testing Hypothesis

- ◆ The Atomic model attracts users because of low commitment.
- ◆ The Subscription model attracts established businesses that want simplicity.
- ◆ The Hybrid model creates stronger retention because management tools become part of daily operations.

The MVP test will determine the best long-term monetization strategy.